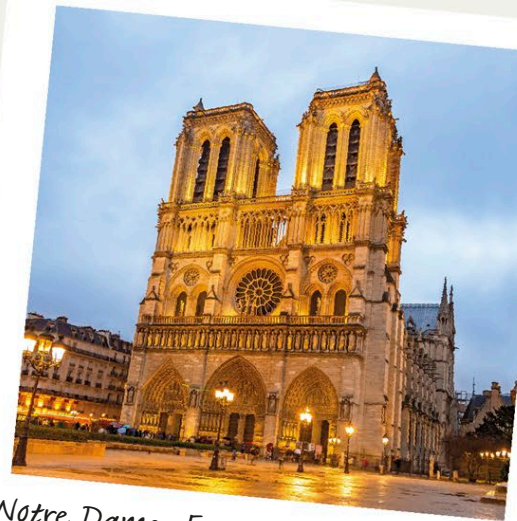


The Middle Ages

During the Middle Ages, Europe was made up of many kingdoms. This was a period when noblemen lived in castles and fought in wars, riding into battle as knights on horseback. The Christian Church was rich and powerful, building great cathedrals across Europe.



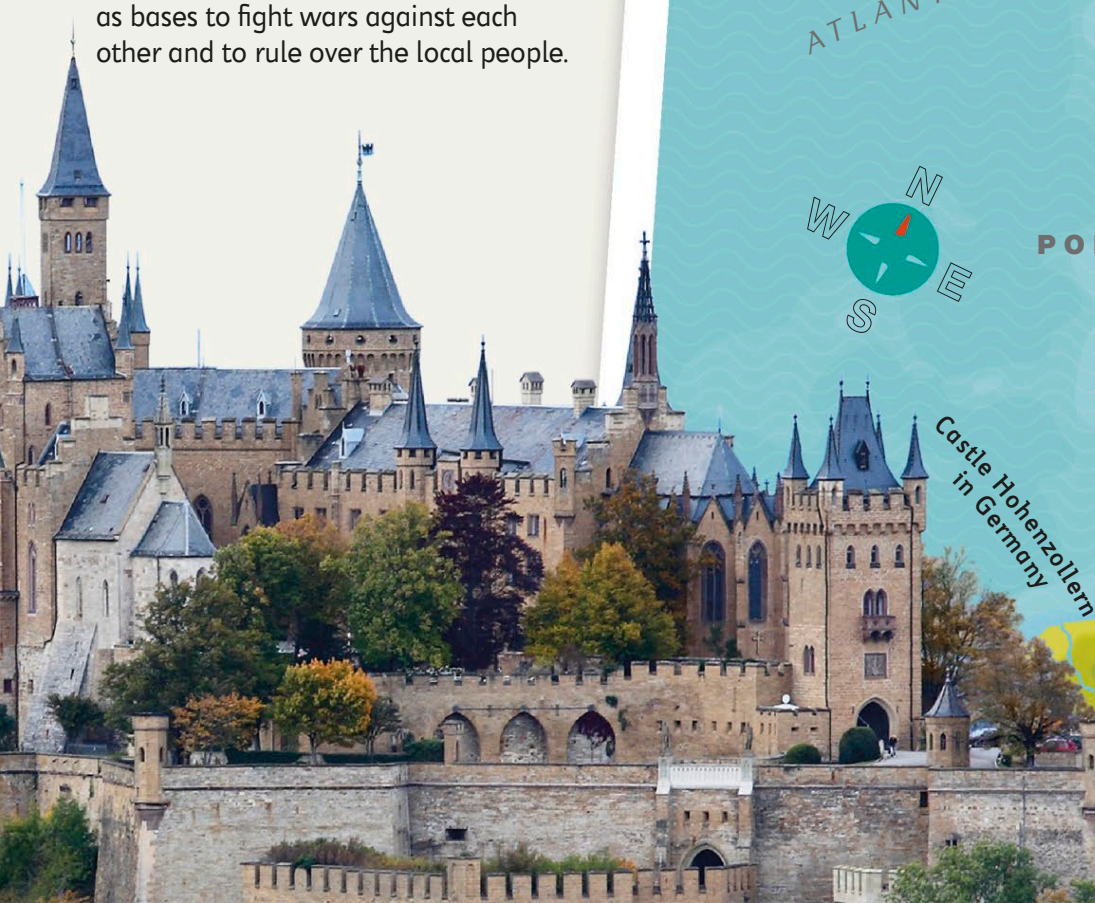
Notre Dame, France, founded in 1163



Stained glass image of Joan of Arc

European castles

Kings and nobles built hundreds of castles across Europe. They used them as bases to fight wars against each other and to rule over the local people.



Cathedrals around Europe

The biggest buildings in medieval Europe were cathedrals. These were big churches where archbishops based their power. Some cathedrals held the body parts of saints, called relics. People traveled on long journeys, called pilgrimages, to visit these relics.

Joan of Arc

From 1337 to 1453, England and France fought a war, later called the Hundred Years' War. Joan of Arc, a peasant girl, helped lead the French to victory.

